



LET US ARM. LET US FIGHT FOR OUR BROTHERS

THE EXPEDITION OF THE THOUSAND (1860)

IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

Nationalism

BEFORE

1830 Greece obtains its independence from the Ottomans.

1848 Nationalist revolutions sweeping across Central Europe and Italy are crushed.

1859 Austria is driven out of Lombardy, which is then annexed by Piedmont.

AFTER

1861 The Italian kingdom is established.

1866 Austria is forced to cede Venetia in northeast Italy to the new Italian kingdom.

1870 The Papal States are incorporated within Italy.

1871 Germany is united under Prussian control. Rome is declared the capital of Italy.

Ideas of **national self-determination**, inspired by the **French Revolution**, begin to proliferate across Europe.



The **Greek War of Independence** epitomizes the struggles necessary to free nations from **foreign domination**.



The **failed revolutions of 1848** illustrate the **ruling elites' resistance** to notions of national independence.



Garibaldi lands in Sicily and overthrows the Kingdom of the Two Sicilies, but Italy remains a constitutional monarchy.



German unification under Prussia reinforces **conservative nationalism** at the expense of **republican liberties**.

On May 11, 1860, the Italian patriot and guerrilla fighter Giuseppe Garibaldi landed in Sicily, then part of the Bourbon-ruled Kingdom of the Two Sicilies, in southern Italy, leading a force of volunteers drawn from across Italy and just over 1,000 strong, hence their name, *I Mille* (The Thousand). Their goal

was to overthrow the Bourbons, but there was much uncertainty as to what government would replace the ruling family.

Like the other great 19th-century stalwart of Italian liberty, Giuseppe Mazzini, who in 1849 had briefly established a Roman republic, Garibaldi was committed to ending royal, clerical, and aristocratic privilege.